

Álvaro Canalejo-Molero

Postdoctoral Researcher, Department of Political Science, University of Lucerne
Frohburgstrasse, 3 · 6002 · Lucerne, Switzerland

✉ alvaro.canalejo@unilu.ch 📞 0000-0001-7980-0702 🌐 [acanalejo.github.io](https://github.com/acanalejo)

Employment

University of Lucerne

Postdoctoral Researcher 2022 - current

External Lecturer 2022

Visiting Positions

Autonomous University of Barcelona (hosted by *Enrique Hernández*) 2025

London School of Economics & Political Science (hosted by *Chris J. Anderson*) 2021

Education

PhD in Political and Social Sciences, *European University Institute* 2023

Committee: Hanspeter Kriesi (supervisor), Elias Dinas, Chris J. Anderson, Ruth Dassonneville

MRes in Political and Social Sciences, *European University Institute* 2019

MSc in Social Sciences, *Carlos III-Juan March Institute, University Carlos III of Madrid* 2018

— First Class

Peer-Reviewed Publications

1. Padilla-Galviz, E.S., & Canalejo-Molero, Á. (2026). The winner–loser gap in democratic attitudes among politicians: Individual and collective outcomes. *European Journal of Political Research*, 1–22. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S1475676526101662>
2. Le Corre Juratic, M., & Canalejo-Molero, Á. (2026). Blinded by out-group hatred: Why does radical party entry fail to boost its voters' satisfaction with democracy? *European Political Science Review*, 1–20. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S1755773926100575>
 - *Djof Forlag Prize for the best paper presented by a junior researcher at the 2023 DPSA conference*
 - *Wilson Award for the best paper on French politics presented at the 2022 APSA meeting*
3. Canalejo-Molero, Á., Cicchi, L., Ferreira da Silva, F., Garzia, D., Reiljan, A., & Trechsel, A. H. (2026). Priming common European and democratic values does not reduce affective polarization. *European Political Science Review*, 1–20. [doi:10.1017/S1755773926100496](https://doi.org/10.1017/S1755773926100496)
4. Moreno-Torres, J. P., Canalejo-Molero, Á., & López Ortega, A. (2025). When the party is over: Explaining the rise of the Spanish far-right SALF. *Research & Politics*, 12(3). <https://doi.org/10.1177/20531680251357602>

Other Publications

1. Cicchi, L., Reiljan, A., Canalejo-Molero, Á., Ferreira da Silva, F., Garzia, D., Trechsel, A. H., & Fiselier, T. A. G. (2026). *EU&I 2024 party and user dataset*. EUI, RSC, Research Data.
2. Canalejo-Molero, Á. (2023). *New party entry and political engagement: electoral turnout and satisfaction with democracy*. Florence: European University Institute, EUI, SPS, PhD Thesis.

Working papers

Canalejo-Molero, Á. & Le Corre Juratic, M. *When Losers Dissent: Affective Polarization and the Logic of Contestation* (Under review, BJPols)

Canalejo-Molero, Á. *Boost or Backlash? The Heterogeneous Effects of Parliamentary Representation on Satisfaction with Democracy* [Preprint]

Canalejo-Molero, Á., López Ortega, A. & Moreno-Torres, J. P. *A Theory of Relative State Devolution Preferences: Evidence and Implications* (Working paper available upon request)

Ferreira da Silva, F., Canalejo-Molero, Á., Cicchi, L., Garzia, D., Reiljan, A. & Trechsel A. H. *Reducing Partisan Animosity with Voting Advice Applications (VAAs)* (Working paper available upon request)

Canalejo-Molero, Á., Bürgisser, R., van Ditmars, M. M. & Trechsel, A. H. *The Political Conflict Potential of Digitalization* (Working paper available upon request)

Canalejo-Molero, Á. *Disruptive Elections and their Implications for Satisfaction with Democracy* (Working paper available upon request)

Canalejo-Molero, Á. *Does New Party Entry Increase Electoral Turnout? Quasi-Experimental Evidence from the 2015 Spanish Local Elections* (Working paper available upon request)

Work in Progress

The Politicization of Digitalization (with Flechtner, M. & Trechsel, A. H.)

Understanding losers' consent and its withdrawal (with Jurado, I. & Serrano-Serrat, J.)

Early political socialization and school-based interventions (with Trechsel, A. H.)

Internal Migration and Regional Devolution Preferences (López Ortega, A. & Moreno-Torres, J. P)

The Political Consequences of Caregiving Policies (with Caihuelas Navajas, B. & Martín Cadenas, P.)

Research Grants (as PI or Co-PI)

UniLu FoKo Preparatory Funding (22,330 CHF $\approx$ 24,153€), with Trechsel, A. H. 2026

UniLu FaFoFö Funding (2,000 CHF $\approx$ 2,142€) 2025

Small Grant Aarhus University (35,000 DKK $\approx$ 4,686€), with Le Corre Juratic, M. 2024

UniLu FoKo Project Funding (12,231 CHF $\approx$ 13,101€), with López Ortega, A. & Padilla Moreno-Torres, J. 2023

EUI Mission Funding for Research Activities (2,547€), with Le Corre Juratic, M. 2022

Additional Experience in Research Projects

[DIGIPOL](#) (Scientific Coordinator), [EU&I 2024](#) (Scientific Committee), [SOLID](#), [POLCON](#), [EUANDI2019](#), [¿Por qué odiamos la política?](#), [Parlamentarios y Sociedad](#), [ICOSOP](#)

Invited Talks and Workshops (selected)

ECPR Joint Sessions	2025
UAB DEC Seminar	2025
UB Workshop on The Political Economy of AI	2024
UZH-DSI Digital Democracy Workshop	2024, 2025
IPP-CSIC Research Seminar	2024
EUI Towards Affective Depolarization Workshop	2024
Luiss Guido Carli Cluster of Excellence on Elections (CISE) Seminar	2024
EU Comission - Joint Research Centre (JRC) DIGCLASS Workshop	2023
CERIUM-FMSH New Challenges to Democracy Workshop	2022

Conference Presentations (selected)

American Political Science Association (APSA)	2024, 2023*, 2022
European Political Science Association (EPSA)	2025, 2024*, 2023*, 2022, 2021
European Political Science Society	2026*
European Consortium of Political Research (ECPR)	2026*, 2025*, 2024*, 2023*
Council of European Studies (CES)	2023
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)	2025*, 2023
International Political Science Association (IPSA)	2025
Computational Text Analysis Conference (COMPTTEXT)	2023
Swiss Political Science Association (SPSA)	2026, 2025*, 2024
Spanish Political Science Association (AECPA)	2026*, 2024

*Accepted but not attended, or not yet attended.

Teaching

Graduate level

[Research Design and Methods in Quantitative Research](#), *University of Lucerne* 2024, 2025

Undergraduate level

[The Politics of Democratic Backsliding](#), *University of Lucerne* 2026

Culture and Politics , <i>University of Lucerne</i>	2024, 2025
Electoral Behavior and Party Competition: Continuity and Change in WE , <i>University of Lucerne</i>	2022, 2023

Supervision

Ten MA theses (five as main supervisors) and nine BA theses (all as main supervisors), including *expected*.

Public Outreach

[Cadena Ser](#), [El Periódico](#), [Onda Cero](#), [VoxEurop](#), [Times of Malta](#), [The Irish Times](#), [Fondation Maison des sciences de l'homme](#), [ElPaís](#) (1, 2)

Scholarships & Awards (selected)

Erasmus+ Scholarship for Visiting PhDs, <i>European Comission</i>	2021
Salvador de Madariaga doctoral Scholarship, <i>Spanish Ministry of Education & European Comission</i>	2018 - 2023
UC3M Scholarship of Excellence for Graduate Studies, <i>University Carlos III of Madrid</i>	2017 - 2018
Best GPA of the Promotion Award, <i>University Pablo de Olavide</i>	2016

Professional Service

Member of the Editorial Board of the Swiss Political Science Review	2026 - current
Convenor of the <i>PolSem</i> Brown Bag Seminar, <i>University of Lucerne</i>	2023 - 2026
Co-organiser of the Political Behaviour Colloquium , <i>European University Institute</i>	2020 - 2021

Journal Reviews

Invited reviewer for *American Journal of Political Science*, *Journal of Politics*, *Comparative Political Studies*, *European Journal of Political Research*, *Public Opinion Quarterly*, *Government & Opposition*, *Research and Politics*, *Politics & Governance*, *Acta Politica*, *Swiss Political Science Review* and *German Politics*

Professional Associations Membership

[APSA](#), [EPSS](#), [EPSA](#), [ECPR](#), [IPSA](#), [DSI](#), [AECPA](#)

Additional Training

Oxford Spring School in Advanced Research Methods, <i>Oxford University</i>	2023
EUI Introduction to Teaching in Higher Education, <i>European University Institute</i>	2020
6th Leuven-Montréal Winter School on Elections, <i>University of Montréal</i>	2020
RECSM-UPF Summer School in Survey Methodology, <i>Pompeu-Fabra University</i>	2019

Skills

Programming: *R (advanced), Python (beginner)*

Statistical Software: *RStudio, Stata, SPSS, Excel*

Surveys: *Qualtrics*

Version Control System: *GitHub*

Text Processor: *Quarto, Overleaf, L^AT_EX, Office*

Reference Management: *Zotero*

Languages: *English (proficient), Spanish (native), Italian (advanced), French (beginner), German (beginner)*

Referees

Prof. Hanspeter Kriesi

PhD Supervisor

SPS Part-Time Professor

European University Institute

hanspeter.kriesi@alumniprofs.eui.eu

Prof. Alexander H. Trechsel

Postdoc Supervisor

Chair of Political Behaviour & Communication

University of Lucerne

alexander.trechsel@unilu.ch